

Unit 6 assessment

Unit summary

Continuous professional development is the ongoing process by which a professional maintains and extends the knowledge, judgement and skill the work requires. It is not a training course, a qualification or an appraisal requirement: it is driven by the practitioner, continuous, and measured by changed practice rather than attendance. It is obligatory because the knowledge base changes, the pupils change, initial preparation cannot be complete by construction, and the alternative to examined practice is drift toward convenience rather than stability.

Development that changes practice is sustained, embedded in the teacher's own classroom, focused on specific content and pupils, collaborative, supported by feedback on real practice, and chosen rather than assigned. Most available provision violates all six at once.

A career passes through three stages. Preservice ends when responsibility transfers; its difficulty is that everything is new at once and it needs structured practice with feedback. The new teacher stage begins abruptly with full responsibility; its difficulty is survival and it needs a mentor, reduced load and help with what is actually blocking the teacher. The experienced stage is longest and least served: attention is free so capacity is highest, while external pressure is lowest, which is where drift operates. At every stage the support offered tends to mismatch the support needed.

Five routes are suited to different things. Conferences buy exposure at the highest cost per teacher; workshops transmit a technique and cannot produce the practice, though a participant can supply the missing principles; online platforms buy reach with mixed evidence and cannot observe you; professional learning communities satisfy more principles than any other route and cost only protected time; reflective tools range from journals to lesson study, where observers watch the pupils rather than the teacher.

A plan is one page with six blocks: the gap, the evidence for it, one goal, the activity, the evidence of change, and a review date. Four things destroy a plan:

too many goals, no time made, no evidence decided in advance, and no review. At the review, continuing, narrowing or replacing the goal are all legitimate; quiet abandonment is not.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. Continuing professional development differs from a training course chiefly in that development is: (*Understand*) a) longer b) driven by the practitioner, continuous, and measured by changed practice c) certified by an external body d) required by an employer
2. Eleven attendance certificates and no change in teaching demonstrate: (*Apply*) a) a lazy teacher b) that evaluation stopped at attendance rather than reaching changed practice c) that the workshops were on the wrong subject d) that the teacher needs a qualification
3. "The alternative to development is not stability but drift" means that unexamined practice: (*Understand*) a) stays the same indefinitely b) slowly adapts toward convenience without anyone deciding c) improves automatically with experience d) becomes more demanding over time
4. Which principle does a one-day generic workshop most obviously violate? (*Remember*) a) chosen rather than assigned b) sustained over time c) collaborative d) all of the above
5. The new teacher transition is described as unusually abrupt because a new teacher: (*Understand*) a) has less subject knowledge than a trainee b) frequently carries the same load as a colleague of twenty years from the first week c) is not permitted to ask for help d) has no qualification
6. The experienced teacher stage is the least served because: (*Analyze*) a) experienced teachers refuse development b) capacity for development is highest while external pressure toward it is lowest c) no suitable provision exists anywhere d) experienced teachers have finished learning

7. Which route satisfies the largest number of the six principles? *(Remember)*
a) a conference b) a workshop c) a professional learning community d) an online platform
8. In lesson study, observers watch the pupils rather than the teacher chiefly because it: *(Apply)* a) is easier b) removes defensiveness and directs attention to what a teacher cannot see while teaching c) avoids the need for planning d) produces a record for appraisal
9. The single most common reason a development plan fails is: *(Remember)* a) the goal was too difficult b) there were too many goals c) the school did not approve it d) the teacher changed schools
10. At a mid-year review, narrowing the goal is best understood as: *(Understand)* a) a failure of ambition b) a legitimate outcome and the commonest one c) evidence the plan was written badly d) grounds for abandoning the plan

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Distinguish continuing professional development from a training course, a qualification and an appraisal requirement, by what each is for and who drives it. *(Understand)*
2. Give four reasons continuing development is obligatory rather than optional, and explain the drift argument in your own words. *(Understand)*
3. Name the six principles of development that changes practice, and state what any three of them rule out. *(Remember)*
4. Name the three career stages and state what changes at each transition. *(Remember)*
5. Sana and Imran both know about wait time and neither uses it. Explain why, and show that the reasons differ by stage. *(Analyze)*
6. Explain why capacity for development and pressure toward it are inversely arranged in the experienced stage, and what follows for how that stage must be served. *(Analyze)*

7. Give the three things a participant can do to convert a workshop into development, naming the principle each supplies. *(Apply)*
8. State what the review of technology for teacher development in low- and middle-income countries reports, and name two constraints on online platforms in Pakistani conditions. *(Understand)*
9. Name the six blocks of a one-page development plan and state what each one prevents. *(Remember)*
10. Explain why a plan written for an appraiser will be useless, referring to the separation of development from judgement. *(Analyze)*

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. Mr Naeem has eleven certificates and no change in practice. Diagnose why against the six principles, separate the provider's failures from his own, and design one activity that a real Pakistani government school could support. *(Create)*
2. A district has budget for one professional development intervention, for all teachers, once a year. Using the three stages, argue what it should spend it on and answer the objection from whichever group you do not serve. *(Evaluate)*
3. A head teacher has twelve teachers and a small budget. Compare at least three routes on cost, reach and the six principles, make a recommendation, state what is given up, and specify how the arrangement is protected from what ordinarily destroys it. *(Evaluate)*
4. "Reflective practice means keeping a journal." Evaluate this claim, distinguishing the four reflective tools by what each can establish, and explain why peer feedback is simultaneously the most valuable and the most avoided. *(Evaluate)*
5. **Integrative, and the closing task of the course.** Write your own one-page professional development plan and defend it. Justify each block: why this gap and what evidence establishes it, why one goal, why this activity given what it can actually deliver, what evidence you will collect and why it

could show you were wrong, and where the time comes from. Draw on at least three earlier units of this course, and finish by naming the plan's own weakest point. *(Create)*

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **b** - all three features together; length alone does not distinguish it.
2. **b** - the certificates are an accurate record of attendance and evaluation never reached practice.
3. **b** - drift is unchosen adaptation toward convenience, which is why it is invisible from inside.
4. **d** - a one-day generic assigned workshop violates sustained, collaborative and chosen at once, which is the point of the example.
5. **b** - the abruptness is about load and accountability, not knowledge.
6. **b** - the inverse arrangement of capacity and pressure is the topic's analytical claim.
7. **c** - sustained, embedded, focused, collaborative and capable of supplying feedback.
8. **b** - the rule removes judgement of the teacher and directs attention to the pupils.
9. **b** - too many goals; Miss Hina's six.
10. **b** - narrowing means the goal met reality, which is the plan working.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. **(8 marks)** Two marks per instrument: what it is for and who drives it.
Development: maintaining and extending capability, driven by the practitioner.
Course: an event, driven by a provider. Qualification: certifying a past threshold, driven by an awarding body. Appraisal requirement: an employer obligation, driven by the employer.
2. **(6 marks)** Knowledge base changes (1); pupils change (1); initial preparation cannot be complete by construction (1); drift (1); drift explained as unchosen adaptation toward convenience (2).

- 3. (9 marks)** Six principles named (6); three "rules out" statements (3).
- 4. (6 marks)** Preservice, new teacher, experienced (3); transitions: responsibility transfers; mechanics become automatic and attention is freed (3).
- 5. (5 marks)** Sana's attention is consumed by mechanics, so there is no spare capacity (2); Imran's block is a class he cannot yet hold, not knowledge (2); concludes that identical knowledge gaps can have different stage-specific causes (1).
- 6. (5 marks)** Mechanics automatic so attention is free, giving highest capacity (2); nothing external requires change, giving lowest pressure (2); therefore development at this stage must be self-driven or it does not occur (1).
- 7. (6 marks)** Decide in advance what single thing to try (1, supplies focus); agree with a colleague to try and compare (2, supplies collaborative and sustained); decide what to look at to know it worked (2, supplies feedback); one mark for correctly pairing principles to actions.
- 8. (5 marks)** Limited, often unsustained provision, not always research-informed; real potential to extend formal and peer learning; outcomes mixed (3); two constraints from data cost, device access, electricity, connectivity (2).
- 9. (12 marks)** Six blocks named (6); what each prevents (6): vagueness, a list of virtues, dilution across many goals, an unchosen activity, a March with nothing to look at, quiet abandonment.
- 10. (4 marks)** A plan feeding judgement is written to look good (1); honest gaps disappear (1); Unit 4's mixed-purpose degradation (1); the remedy that the working document is the teacher's own and a summary can be supplied (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response not reaching "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall.

ERQ 1 - Mr Naeem's eleven certificates

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the principles	Two or three applied	All six applied	Applied to the actual provision described, not to workshops in general
Attribution	Blames the teacher	Separates provider from teacher	Identifies what he could have supplied himself without permission
Design (Create)	Generic proposal	Specific activity	Startable on Monday and supplies the principles the provision violated
Constraint (Evaluate)	Assumes resources	Notes constraints	Designs within the absence of time and colleagues rather than around it

ERQ 2 - One intervention, three stages

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the stages	One or two stages	All three with their needs	Needs stated specifically rather than as "more support"
Recognition of constraint	Proposes three interventions	Accepts one	Explains what makes the choice genuinely exclusive
Defended choice	Preference stated	Choice with reasons	States the criterion and

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
(Evaluate)			answers the group not served
Realism	Not deliverable	Deliverable	Deliverable once a year on a district budget

ERQ 3 - The head's twelve teachers

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Comparison	One route	Three routes on some criteria	Three or more on cost, reach and principles
What is given up	Not stated	Stated	Stated precisely, including who loses
Protection (Create)	None	General intent	Concrete defences against the three named failure modes
Constraint (Evaluate)	Assumes protected time	Notes the difficulty	Argues whether a head in an understaffed school can actually defend it

ERQ 4 - Is reflective practice a journal?

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
The four tools	Fewer than four	All four named	Each distinguished by what it can establish
Grasp of reflection	Treated as disposition	Treated as method	Shows why evidence, not feeling, is what makes it reflection
Evaluating the claim (Evaluate)	Asserts it is wrong	Argues it is wrong	Concedes what is right in it before showing what it misses
Peer feedback	Mentioned	Explained	Explains the value and the avoidance together, including the appraisal link

ERQ 5 - Your own plan, defended (integrative)

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
The plan itself	Blocks missing	All six present	The gap is stated so an observer could confirm or disconfirm it
Fit of the activity	Chosen by preference	Justified	Justified against what that route can actually deliver
Evidence design (Create)	Vague or retrospective	Decided in advance	Capable of showing the goal was not met, and the candidate says so

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the course and self-diagnosis (Evaluate)	No earlier units used	Draws on three units	Uses them substantively and names the plan's own weakest point honestly

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

Give feedback